

BENJAMIN KIRCHLER (MSc)

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied behavioural and energy economics, with a focus on randomised field experiments and econometric policy evaluation. My work examines how information design, social norms and tariff structures shape household energy demand – and how climate policy instruments such as carbon pricing and climate dividends distribute their effects across income groups. Methodologically I combine experimental and quasi-experimental designs; thematically my work sits at the intersection of behavioural economics, regulatory economics and public policy.

EDUCATION

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| 2023/10–2026 | Doctoral Programme in Social and Economic Sciences
Wirtschaftsuniversität Wien (WU) · Wien, AT <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Economics (major) & Economic Psychology (minor)• Dissertation: <i>Behavioural Field Studies on Electricity Consumption</i> |
| 2019/10–2021/12 | MSc in Economics – Applied Track
Wirtschaftsuniversität Wien (WU) · Wien, AT <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Behavioural Economics, Distributional Economics, Economic Policy, Data Science & Machine Learning• Thesis: <i>The Impact of Social Reference Points on Decisions under Risk & Ambiguity</i> — under review (<i>Journal of Economic Psychology</i>) |
| 2017/10–2018/02 | Exchange Semester
Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin · Berlin, DE |
| 2015/10–2019/08 | BSc Business, Economics and Social Sciences
Wirtschaftsuniversität Wien (WU) · Wien, AT <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Focus: Economics & Socioeconomics |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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| Since Dec 2023 | Research Associate
Energieinstitut at Johannes Kepler University (JKU), Department of Energy Economics · Linz, AT <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Design and empirical analysis of field experiments, household surveys and energy economics datasets• Management of empirical research processes including study design, data collection, analysis, replication materials and manuscript preparation• Contribution to grant proposals and interdisciplinary collaborations on energy behaviour, tariffs and distributional effects of the energy transition |
| 2021/11–2023/11 | Junior Researcher
Energieinstitut an der Johannes Kepler Universität (JKU) · Linz, AT <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Empirical research projects on energy and consumer behaviour: design, data collection, data preparation and analysis with R and Stata• Support in scientific analysis, project reporting and publication processes in international research consortia |
| 2019/10–2021/06 | Research Assistant – Marketing & Consumer Research
Wirtschaftsuniversität Wien (WU) · Wien, AT |

- Support of experimental studies and surveys on consumer behaviour and decision-making processes

2019/08–2019/09

Internship – Economics Department

Oesterreichische Nationalbank (OeNB) · Wien, AT

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- Tiberio, Lorenza et al. (2025). “Unveiling the power of social norms interventions: Investigating energy savings behaviour in an Italian energy cooperative.” In: *Energy Research & Social Science* 122, p. 103989.
- Habibi Asgarabad, Mojtaba et al. (2024). “Promoting electricity conservation through behaviour change: A study protocol for a web-based multiple-arm parallel randomised controlled trial.” In: *PLOS ONE* 19.3, e0293683.
- Kirchler, Benjamin, Andrea Kollmann, Anca Sinea, and Clara Volintiru (2024). “Behavioural insights into energy consumption in times of crisis.” In: *Energy Research & Social Science* 117, p. 103744.

Under Review

- Kirchler, Benjamin, Andrea Kollmann, Johannes Reichl, and Jed Cohen (2025). “The Role of Emotional Attachment in Crowdfunding Renewable Energy Initiatives.” Under review, *Energy Research & Social Science*.
- Kirchler, Benjamin and Erich Kirchler (2024). “Social Reference Points Shape Decisions under Uncertainty.” Under review, *Journal of Economic Psychology*.

Working Papers & Preprints

- Kirchler, Benjamin, Andrea C. Kollmann, and Johannes Reichl (2025). “More Information, Less Power: Field Experimental Evidence on the Effect of Information Provision on Residential Electricity Consumption.” Working Paper.
- Löckner, Christian et al. (2024). “Advancing Realistic Estimations of Behavioural Interventions: A Large-Scale Real-World Experiment on Electricity Consumption Reduction in Europe.” SSRN Working Paper 5146234.

SELECTED PROJECTS

2026/06–2028/05

RLD

Reference Load Dataset for Distribution System Operators

€800k | FFG

Development of a statistically representative load dataset at DSO level as a basis for forecasting and data-driven grid models.

- **Contribution:** Project contribution; data analysis, simulation and forecasting in cooperation with Energienetze Steiermark and Kärnten Netz

Since Mar 2026

GridCommunity

Grid-Friendly Energy Communities & Cost-Reflective Tariffs

Analysis of market incentives, tariff structures and operating models that enable energy communities to provide grid-supporting services.

- **Contribution:** Project lead; data analysis, tariff model simulations and assessment of cost-reflectiveness and regulatory implications

2025/11–2028/11

ACTWELL

Climate Adaptation & Well-being in Austria

ACRP 2024

Development of the *Adaptation Wedges Concept* (AWC) to assess welfare and distributional effects of climate adaptation measures; behavioural experiments, surveys and soft-linking with the MIWAG model.

- **Contribution:** Project coordination (JKU); design and implementation of behavioural experiments and empirical surveys; causal analysis of adaptation measures and well-being; soft-linking with partners IHS and IIASA

2025/04–2028/03	ADJUST Towards a Just Energy Transition €350k ACRP Analysis of the social and distributional effects of carbon pricing and climate bonus on Austrian households. • Contribution: Household-level econometric analysis; distributional modelling; design of equity-compatible pricing systems
2025/01–2030/12	HI2 Valley Hydrogen Industrial Inland Valley Horizon Europe Clean Hydrogen Large European hydrogen project on industrial decarbonisation, energy resilience and market ramp-up. • Contribution: Project contribution; socioeconomic, regulatory and acceptance-related questions
2024/04–2027/03	POWERCAST AI-Supported Load Forecasting for Power Grids FFG AI for Green Development of adaptive AI methods to improve load forecasts and early-warning systems for negative loads. • Contribution: Project contribution; energy-economics analysis and interface to data, grid and stakeholder questions
2024/03–2026/10	INNOnet Interactive Network Optimisation & Tariffs €1.8M FFG Regulatory sandbox field experiment testing dynamic network tariffs and their effect on household demand and electric vehicles. • Contribution: Internal project lead; tariff design; field trial planning; coordination with network operators, ministries and regulators; data analysis and reporting (HAKOM, Python, R)
2024/01–2027/06	MultiFutures Alternative Sustainable Futures €4.5M EU Horizon Europe Development of alternative economic paradigms and evidence-based policy options for sustainable transformation pathways in Europe. • Contribution: Co-author of the funding proposal; tax and levy analysis; scenario development; macroeconomic simulations
2022/01–2026/12	CURE Conceptualizing and Understanding Resistance Norwegian Research Council Study of actors, forms and effects of active resistance to low-carbon transitions. • Contribution: Project contribution; analysis of acceptance, resistance, behaviour and policy implications
2022/01–2024/12	GREENFOOT Energy Citizenship for Football Fans €1.5M EU Horizon 2020 Behavioural online experiments promoting sustainable crowdfunding investment in professional football clubs. • Contribution: Design and analysis of two online experiments; investigation of incentives, social identity and climate behaviour
2020/10–2024/02	ENCHANT Energy Efficiency through Behaviour Change €2.0M EU Horizon 2020 Large-scale randomised field experiments on energy and mobility behaviour across six European countries. • Contribution: Design and econometric analysis of multiple RCTs; co-development of online behavioural platform; policy recommendations

TEACHING

- 2025/03–2025/10 **Lecturer, Public Economics**
Wirtschaftsuniversität Wien (WU) · Wien, AT
• Undergraduate course “Public Finance” in the BSc Business and Social Sciences programme (approx. 60 students)
- 2021/10–2022/03 **Teaching Assistant, Public Finance**
Wirtschaftsuniversität Wien (WU) · Wien, AT
• Tutorial sessions for the Public Finance lecture; exam preparation and individual student support

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 SDEWES Conference, *Presentation*, Dubrovnik, HR
- 2025 IMH Energietage / EPCON Energy Congress, *Panel Discussion*, Wien, AT
- 2024 IMH Energietage, *Talk*, Wien, AT
- 2024 Forum Econogy – INNOnet, *Presentation*, Linz, AT
- 2024 ENinnov Conference, *Talk*, Graz, AT
- 2024 Forum Econogy – INNOnet, *Presentation*, Linz, AT
- 2023 International Conference on Energy Research and Social Science, *Poster*, UK
- 2023 IEWT Conference, *Poster*, Wien, AT

METHODS & SOFTWARE

- Quantitative Methods** Econometrics, causal inference, difference-in-differences, panel data, time-series analysis, forecasting and machine learning
- Study Design & Data** Randomised controlled trials, field and online experiments, household, survey, smart-meter and energy data
- Statistical Software** R (primary), Stata, Python (working knowledge), SPSS and Qualtrics
- Reproducible Research** Git/GitHub, R Markdown, L^AT_EX/Overleaf, HAKOM/API interfaces, replication packages, OSF and AI-supported analysis workflows
- Research & Project Management** Project and work-package leadership, grant proposals, interdisciplinary consortia and stakeholder coordination
- Research Communication** Manuscripts, peer review, project reports, policy-oriented writing, conference presentations and decision-support materials

LANGUAGES

- German** – Native
- English** – Fluent, C1
- Italian** – Second language, B2
- Portuguese** – Basic knowledge, A2